

Lesson 11

Updating and Delegating Tasks



Warm-Up

Task Delegation Discussion

- Have you ever had to delegate a task? How did you do it?

Workplace Task Example: fixing a bug, updating software, writing a report

- Tell which task(s) you would delegate and to whom.



Role-Play

Scenario: Emma, a project manager, is delegating a task to Tom, a software developer. Later, Tom provides an update on his progress.

Emma: Hi Tom, could you take care of testing the new feature before Friday?

Tom: Sure, I can do that. Do you need a detailed report on the test results?

Emma: Yes, please. Make sure to check for any security issues and report any bugs.

Tom: Got it. I'll start today and keep you updated.

(Later in the week...)

Emma: Hi Tom, how is the testing going?

Tom: I've completed most of the tests, but I found a security issue that needs to be fixed. It might take an extra day to resolve.

Emma: Thanks for the update. Let me know when it's fixed.

Tom: Will do!

Role-play Analysis

1. What task did Emma delegate to Tom?
2. What instructions did Emma give about the task?
3. How did Tom update Emma about the task's progress?
4. What issue did Tom find during testing?
5. How did Emma respond to the update?

Discussion

- What challenges do you face when delegating or reporting on tasks in English?



Practice

A. Fill in the Blanks (Choose the correct words from the word bank)

progress	behind	take care of	update	completed
make sure	on track	issue	delay	handle

1. Could you _____ the client's request by the end of the day?
2. I've made some _____ on the report and will finish it soon.
3. We are _____ schedule due to a technical problem.
4. Please _____ to review the document before submitting it.
5. The project is _____ and should be finished by Friday.
6. There is a small _____ with the software, but we are fixing it.
7. Can you give me an _____ on the progress of your task?
8. We might need to _____ the database migration next week.
9. The work has been _____, and we are ready for the next step.
10. We need to inform the client about the _____ in delivery.

B. Matching

Instructions: Match the phrases with their functions: Type in the chat box whether it's *Delegating* or *Updating*.

Phrase	Function
1. Could you handle the testing process?	
2. The report is almost finished.	
3. We're running behind schedule due to a delay.	
4. I'd like you to take care of this task.	
5. Please make sure to double-check the data.	
6. The team has already completed the first phase.	
7. I'll need you to finish this by tomorrow.	
8. The update is taking longer than expected.	
9. Can you give me a status update?	
10. There's a small issue, but we're working on it.	



Production

Speaking Practice for Updating and Delegating Tasks

1. Work in pairs (Manager & Employee).
2. Switch roles after each round.

Scenario 1: Delegating a Task

Manager: Assign a report-writing task to your team member. Include details (deadline, key points to cover, format).

Employee: Ask for clarification if needed and confirm understanding.

Scenario 2: Providing a Task Update

Employee: You are working on a project and your manager asks for an update. Report your progress, any issues, and estimated completion time.

Manager: Ask follow-up questions and provide feedback.

Discussion

- *Why is it important to set a deadline when delegating a task?*
- *What strategies can help when facing a delay in completing a task?*
- *Was it difficult to describe your workplace?*



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Delegate	To assign a task to someone else	<i>I will delegate the report-writing task to Sarah.</i>
Deadline	The final date by which a task must be completed	<i>The deadline for the project is next Friday.</i>
On track	Moving forward as planned or expected	<i>The project is on track for completion next week.</i>
Could you take care of...?	Requesting someone to do a task	<i>Could you take care of the client emails today?</i>
This task needs to be done by...	Used to set a deadline	<i>This task needs to be done by next Wednesday.</i>



Wrap-Up

What's one area you want to improve when updating or delegating tasks?